

When They Ask About a Failure

Show ownership and learning without turning the story into blame or performance.

WHAT THIS EDITION HELPS YOU DO

Prepare a responsible answer that describes what changed in your judgment or operating practice.

HOW TO USE THE WORKING PAGE

Read this preview, then complete the next page before your next application, interview or offer conversation. The value is not in collecting advice; it is in making a decision visible enough to act on.

This is a sample briefing for educational reading. It is not a historic newsletter send and does not guarantee an interview, offer or outcome. Framework reference: [MIT Career Advising & Professional Development — STAR method](#).

Make the next step concrete.

Which setback can you discuss with honesty, appropriate context and a clear learning?

WORK THROUGH THESE THREE PROMPTS

State what happened without changing the facts or blaming another person.

Name the part you owned and the decision you would now approach differently.

Describe the practice, checkpoint or question you added afterward.

YOUR ONE-SENTENCE COMMITMENT

The action I will take before my next career decision is:

Educational guidance only. Further reading: [MIT Career Advising & Professional Development — STAR method](#).